Examples of developmental tasks

S. N.	Developmental areas	Examples
1	Gross motor	Sitting, walking, running, climbing & jumping etc
2	Fine motor	Hand skills like writing, buttoning, holding objects and visual development
3	Cognitive development	Thinking, decision making, recalling, learning of maths etc.,
4	Speech, Language and hearing development	Speaking, understanding language, replying and responding by verbal and non verbal communication
5	Personal social behavior development	Feeding, toileting, dressing, establishing and maintaining social relationship.

Assessment of development

Development can be assessed under various categories. They are

- Motor (gross and fine motor) development
- Speech, Language and hearing development
- Cognitive development
- Personal social behavior development

Principles of growth and development

- Growth is a continuous process
- Growth is an orderly process
- There is period of rapid growth and slow growth
- Growth follows a sequence
- Growth proceeds from general to specific
- Head grows faster than the body and extremities
- Growth pattern is same for all children
- Rate of development varies from child to child
- Boys and girls grow differently

Factors influencing growth

Growth is influenced by interaction of both genetic and environmental factors. Children generally grow to their genetic height potential with little outside assistance. Parents have to provide best possible environment for their growth to take place.

Genetic factors: In general, Asians tend to be smaller than Europeans while Afro Americans are taller than white Americans

Parental influence: Tall parents tend to have taller children.

Gender: Boys tend to be taller and heavier than girls

Genetic disorders: Chromosomal disorders such as down syndrome, Turner syndrome and genetic mutations can adversely influence growth.

Prenatal (before delivery) growth: The size at birth is primarily influenced by maternal health and uterine environment. Maternal health condition affects the growth of the foetus. Certain diseases like diabetes, hypertension during pregnancy affects the growth in the uterus.

Post natal (after delivery) growth

Nutrition: Lack of nutrition during first two years of life after birth has remarkable influence on the growth of the child.

Chronic illnesses in children: Congenital heart diseases, recurrent pneumonia, persistent diarrhea, tuberculosis leads to growth failure.

Hormonal influences: Growth hormone and thyroxin deficiency and sex hormone deficiency during puberty affects growth.

Emotional factors: Emotional deprivation, anxiety may affect the child's growth.

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